Operation Steel Opera — Special Instructions

Persian Gulf · Scenario start 1 June 2018, 06:00

operation-steel-opera-spins · Revision draft-4

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1 Applicability and mission basis

1.1 Status. This is a mission-derived SPINS draft for Operation Steel Opera. Mission configuration is stated as configured, not as a live service guarantee. Paragraphs marked “Draft procedure” propose coordination rules for adoption by the mission maker.

1.2 Applicability. These standing instructions apply to runs of the exact source mission identified in the references. They remain a complete baseline until revised; no ATO-period amendment or expiry has been invented.

1.3 Scenario clock. The mission starts on 1 June 2018 at 06:00 on its scenario clock. A UTC offset and end-of-mission time are not established in the archive. Use the same explicitly briefed clock for all launch, entry, support, and recovery times.

1.4 Mission tasking. The source contains no authored Player or Client aircraft and no blue tasking paragraph. Flight callsigns, target assignments, expected standard conventional loads (SCLs), routes, fuel states, and recovery assignments are not supplied. Issue these in flight tasking; a map target label or AI loadout is not a player assignment.

1.5 Draft procedure — flight brief. Before launch, each flight lead shall identify the assigned task, aircraft and SCL, departure and recovery location, alternate, radio plan, fuel limits, planned control-area crossings, and abort conditions. Resolve the open items in the mission-maker annex before using the document as an issued order.

1.6 Weather snapshot. The configured temperature is 40 °C, visibility is 80 km, and cloud-base value is 4,200 m with Preset1. Fog and dust are disabled. Obtain the current in-simulator altimeter setting, runway, wind, and recovery condition; these instructions do not assign a carrier recovery case.

2 Communications, navigation aids, and support

2.1 Frequency basis. Carrier and template data below come from the mission. Airfield VHF channels come from the installed Persian Gulf terrain database. A frequency entry does not establish that a human controller is staffed or that an inactive aircraft has launched.

Table 1. Configured and briefing-listed services

Agency / platform	Radio	Navigation aids	Status / use
CVN-75 Harry S. Truman	127.500 MHz AM	TACAN 75X, ident KU; ICLS 5	Programmed on the carrier. The briefing instead lists TACAN 4X. Resolve this discrepancy before recovery.
ARCO (briefing entry)	210.000 MHz AM	TACAN 11Y	Briefing only. No matching active ARCO service is established by the archive.
E-2C template / MAGIC 1-1	251.000 MHz; AM mode value	No dedicated TACAN recorded	Late activation. No activation action for this group was found in the inspected mission.

Agency / platform	Radio	Navigation aids	Status / use
S-3B tanker template / TEXACO 1-1	251.000 MHz; AM mode value	TACAN 1X, ident TKR in template task	Late activation; does not match the ARCO briefing entry. Not a guaranteed refueling service.
SH-60B template / DODGE 2-1	127.500 MHz; AM mode value	None specified	Late activation; transport task. Presence alone does not establish an available rescue service.

2.2 Draft procedure — initial contact. Identify callsign, number and type of aircraft, position, altitude with reference, intended activity, and requested clearance. Read back the assigned route, altitude, clearance limit, and reporting requirement. Use the actual assigned agency and channel; do not treat the table’s inactive templates as available controllers.

2.3 Draft procedure — support availability. Confirm tanker identity, channel, beacon, station, operating altitude, and availability before relying on aerial refueling. A fuel plan shall remain viable if the unverified support listed above is unavailable.

2.4 Draft procedure — navigation check. For carrier recovery, reconcile the programmed and briefing-listed aids in Table 1 before launch. Verify beacon identification and establish communications before committing to the recovery.

3 Airspace control and restrictions

3.1 Control-measure names. Use the exact mission drawing names in clearances and reports. The mission contains named civil control volumes and a military-route label; its civil-traffic script gives these volumes population-specific behavior. Do not treat every drawn polygon or hidden trigger zone as a general aircraft exclusion area.

Table 2. Mission airspace definitions and civil-traffic limits

Measure	Recorded vertical definition	Scope / qualification
OMDB CTR-E	10,000–28,000 ft MSL in traffic configuration	Drawing reads FL280–10000. Applies to generated civil traffic crossing the polygon.
OMDB CTR-W	10,000–28,000 ft MSL in traffic configuration	Drawing reads FL280–10000. Applies to generated civil traffic crossing the polygon.

Measure	Recorded vertical definition	Scope / qualification
OMDB CTA	Ground–12,000 ft MSL	Dubai terminal area; overlaps must not be assumed to be empty.
OMAA CTR	10,000–28,000 ft MSL	Abu Dhabi civil traffic volume. Drawing reads FL280–10000.
OMAA_APP	4,000–10,000 ft MSL	Abu Dhabi approach volume.
OMAA CTA	Ground–10,000 ft MSL	Abu Dhabi terminal area.
OMRK CTA	Ground–6,500 ft MSL	Traffic-script restriction is filtered to Ras Al Khaimah traffic.
OMFJ CTA	Ground–7,500 ft MSL	Traffic-script restriction is filtered to Fujairah traffic.
MRR1	Map label: FL180–UNLTD; civil script: ground–17,000 ft MSL	Different populations use different vertical definitions. No military level allocation by direction is supplied.
CVN75_CATCC	Civil-traffic exclusion at all altitudes; 5 NM planning buffer	Fixed rectangular drawing. The source does not assign a military entry altitude or moving carrier-control volume.

3.2 Vertical separation from civil traffic

3.2.1 Draft rule — remain above or below. Military flights shall remain outside the vertical limits of the civil traffic volumes unless a crossing has been specifically coordinated. Select an altitude below the civil floor or above the civil ceiling, while respecting the assigned route altitude and terrain clearance. A route drawn through the horizontal footprint does not by itself permit flight within the civil altitude band.

3.2.2 Draft planning margin. For this SPINS, plan at least 1,000 ft below a raised civil floor or above a civil ceiling. This margin is a proposed mission rule. The table uses feet MSL from the traffic configuration. It provides planning limits, not a terrain-clearance guarantee or permission to enter another overlapping volume.

Table 3. Draft military under/over limits — all numeric altitudes in feet MSL

Civil volume	Configured civil band	Underflight limit	Overflight limit
OMDB CTR-E	10,000–28,000	At or below 9,000	At or above 29,000
OMDB CTR-W	10,000–28,000	At or below 9,000	At or above 29,000
OMDB CTA	Ground–12,000	No underflight option	At or above 13,000
OMRK CTA	Ground–6,500	No underflight option	At or above 7,500
OMAA CTR	10,000–28,000	At or below 9,000	At or above 29,000
OMAA_APP	4,000–10,000	At or below 3,000	At or above 11,000
OMAA CTA	Ground–10,000	No underflight option	At or above 11,000
MRR1	Ground–17,000	No underflight option	At or above 18,000
OMFJ CTA	Ground–7,500	No underflight option	At or above 8,500

3.2.3 Ground-based areas. There is no underflight option for a volume extending down to ground. Use its overflight limit or remain laterally outside it. This applies to OMDB CTA, OMAA CTA, OMRK CTA, OMFJ CTA, and the civil-traffic band in MRR1.

3.2.4 Overlapping areas. Remain outside every applicable civil band with the planning margin. Being below one floor can place the aircraft inside another volume. For example, where OMAA_APP (4,000–10,000) and OMAA CTR (10,000–28,000) overlap, the common outside options are at or below 3,000 or at or above 29,000 ft MSL, subject to route and terrain limits. If a ground-based CTA also occupies the lower option, remain above the combined ceiling or outside the overlap.

3.2.5 Climb and descent. Complete the altitude change outside the affected lateral boundary. Do not descend from above a civil volume to below it, or climb from below to above, through occupied civil altitudes without coordinated crossing instructions. If terrain, route restrictions, or aircraft capability prevent an outside altitude, remain clear and obtain a revised route or clearance.

3.2.6 MRR1. The mission places generated civil traffic at or below 17,000 ft MSL in MRR1 and labels the military route FL180–UNLTD. Maintain the assigned military level and at least 1,000 ft above the civil ceiling using a common altitude reference. FL180 is a pressure flight level; confirm the pressure-altitude relationship instead of treating it as exactly 18,000 ft MSL. Other overlapping civil volumes still require coordination.

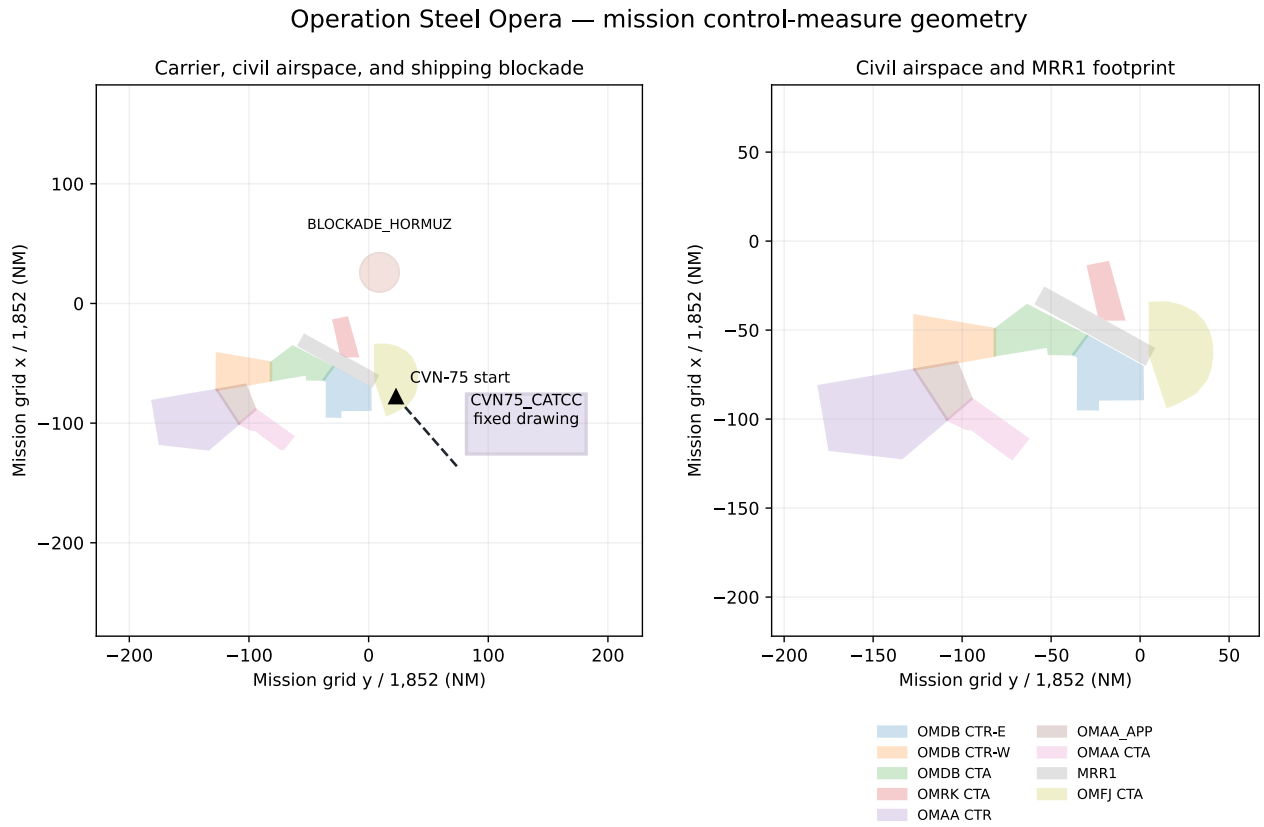
3.2.7 Traffic outside the volumes. The polygons constrain the configured generator, not every possible aircraft. Civil flights also use 30,000–40,000-ft entry/exit levels outside these areas. An overflight altitude clear of one volume does not establish an empty traffic area. Continue traffic checks and avoid using AI routing constraints as guaranteed separation.

3.3 Draft procedure — clearance to enter. Before entering a civil terminal area, CVN75_CATCC, or a crossing involving conflicting traffic, obtain coordination from the designated mission controller. State the measure name, entry point, intended track, altitude, and exit. Report entry and clear. If no controller or published flight deconfliction is available, remain clear until the conflict is resolved.

3.4 Draft procedure — MRR1. Use the drawn MRR1 footprint and the military FL180–UNLTD label in Table 2. Assign a specific direction and flight level during the flight brief. The eastbound and westbound arrows do not themselves allocate odd/even levels or separation. Do not use the civil script’s 17,000-ft ceiling as a military route clearance.

3.5 Draft procedure — civil-area crossing. Apply the underflight or overflight limits in Section 3.2 before crossing a civil footprint. Obtain specific coordination if the planned route requires passage through its civil band. Keep climbs, descents, and holds outside the volume until that coordination is complete.

3.6 CATCC geometry. CVN75_CATCC is a fixed rectangle measuring 185,000 by 92,500 m. The carrier starts outside it: the shortest mission-grid distance from the starting position to the rectangle is about 58.9 NM. It does not follow the ship. Carrier protection and aircraft entry procedures therefore require an explicit mission-maker decision.



Source: exact MIZ drawings and starting positions. Grid schematic; no terrain or geographic conversion.
The civil-traffic script excludes CVN75_CATCC at all altitudes with a 5 NM buffer (buffer not drawn).

Figure 1. Control measures from the source mission. Fixed CATCC drawing and actual carrier start are shown separately.

3.7 Other map features. DAISY, GATSBY, CARRAWAY, and JORDAN are area labels on the map. ADF-1 and ADF-2 are hidden trigger zones without published vertical limits or entry procedures. None of these names alone grants clearance, establishes a weapons-free area, or identifies an assigned target.

4 Airfield operations

4.1 Airfield coordination. The mission contains drawn HI/LO entries for Al Dhafra, including a connection on the Al Minhad side. Its civil-traffic generator separately serves Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, Ras Al Khaimah, and Fujairah. Civil airports and their drawn routes are not automatically military departure, recovery, or alternate assignments.

Table 4. Installed terrain VHF channels

Airfield	Mission / ICAO designation	VHF AM
Al Minhad	OMDM	118.550 MHz
Al Dhafra	OMAM	126.500 MHz

Airfield	Mission / ICAO designation	VHF AM
Dubai International	OMDB	118.750 MHz
Abu Dhabi International	OMAA	119.200 MHz
Sharjah International	OMSJ	118.600 MHz
Ras Al Khaimah International	OMRK	121.600 MHz
Fujairah International	OMFJ	124.600 MHz

4.2 Draft procedure — common departure and recovery. Obtain the active runway and traffic information from local control. Confirm that the runway and departure path are clear before entering or departing. For arrival, report position, altitude, fuel state, intended recovery, and abnormal conditions. Coordinate any alternate or diversion; this SPINS does not assign one.

4.3 Al Dhafra / OMAM — HI and LO entry routes

4.3.1 Procedure names.

names. Use the named arrivals below in flight briefs and on the radio. These are Operation Steel Opera mission procedures. Each title uses a name and revision number, such as OPERA ONE (OPERA1). The names identify the drawn routes; they do not create new navigation fixes. Procedure revision ONE is independent of paragraph numbering and this document’s draft revision.

Table 5. Al Dhafra named arrivals

Arrival / identifier	Entry	Connection
OPERA ONE (OPERA1)	Northern HI	WEST ARC
MINHA ONE (MINHA1)	Al Minhad-side HI	SOUTH ARC / EAST TRANSITION
TENOR ONE (TENOR1)	Outer northeastern HI	NORTH JOIN to OPERA ONE, or EAST TRANSITION as assigned
LYRIC ONE (LYRIC1)	Northwestern LO	OPERA ONE / WEST ARC join; altitude transition requires coordination

4.3.2 OPERA ONE arrival. Use the northern HI entry and its drawn western-side route. The high-route annotation is UNLTD-12000. Continue toward WEST ARC, the nominal 15 DME arc west/northwest of MA, for the assigned airfield entry.

4.3.3 MINHA ONE arrival. Use the HI route from the Al Minhad side. Its straight leg reaches MA and the drawing continues to the southern arc and eastern connection. The high-route annotation is UNLTD-12000. SOUTH ARC is the nominal 15 DME arc south/southeast of MA; use the assigned EAST TRANSITION and recovery clearance.

4.3.4 TENOR ONE arrival. Use the outer northeastern HI entry, annotated UNLTD-12000. At the branching area, take NORTH JOIN toward OPERA ONE, or the eastern continuation when assigned. Include the selected transition in the entry clearance.

4.3.5 LYRIC ONE arrival. Use the northwestern LO entry and its curved route toward OPERA ONE. The source annotation is 4000-8000. Coordinate the altitude change and the WEST ARC connection before joining the high-route structure.

4.3.6 Civil traffic — route-specific application. Apply the vertical limits in Section 3.2 to the named arrival. The source geometry gives the following intersections; the route name and HI/LO label do not override the civil bands.

Table 6. Civil airspace crossed by the Al Dhafra arrival linework

Arrival / segment	Intersected civil volume	Draft vertical guidance
OPERA ONE	OMAA_APP and OMAA CTR	Above OMAA_APP: at or above 11,000 ft MSL. At the CTR crossing: at or below 9,000 or at or above 29,000. Retaining the HI band prevents assuming the lower option; resolve the descent/re-route before entry. Where both volumes overlap, apply the combined limits.
LYRIC ONE	OMAA CTR	The drawn 4,000–8,000 low band is below the 10,000-ft civil floor. Keep at or below 9,000 ft MSL and within the assigned low-route band until clear. Coordinate before climbing into the HI structure.
MINHA ONE	OMAA CTA	Cross above the ground–10,000-ft volume at or above 11,000 ft MSL. Maintain the assigned HI level and delay descent until clear or specifically coordinated.

Arrival / segment	Intersected civil volume	Draft vertical guidance
TENOR ONE	OMDB CTA	Cross above the ground–12,000-ft volume at or above 13,000 ft MSL. Exactly 12,000 is not vertically separated from that civil ceiling.
WEST ARC / SOUTH ARC / EAST TRANSITION / joins	Check each segment	The straight part of MINHA ONE intersects OMAA CTA; the two measured main-arc portions and the other connecting source linework have no positive-length intersection with the configured civil polygons. Continue checking for traffic and any revised clearance.

4.3.7 DME reference. Distance Measuring Equipment (DME) indicates slant-range distance to the selected navigation aid, in nautical miles. Both arcs reference Al Dhafra MA VORTAC: 114.90 MHz / TACAN 96X. Identify MA and use its DME readout. The nominal instruction “15 DME MA” means an indicated distance of 15 NM from MA. Reference 5

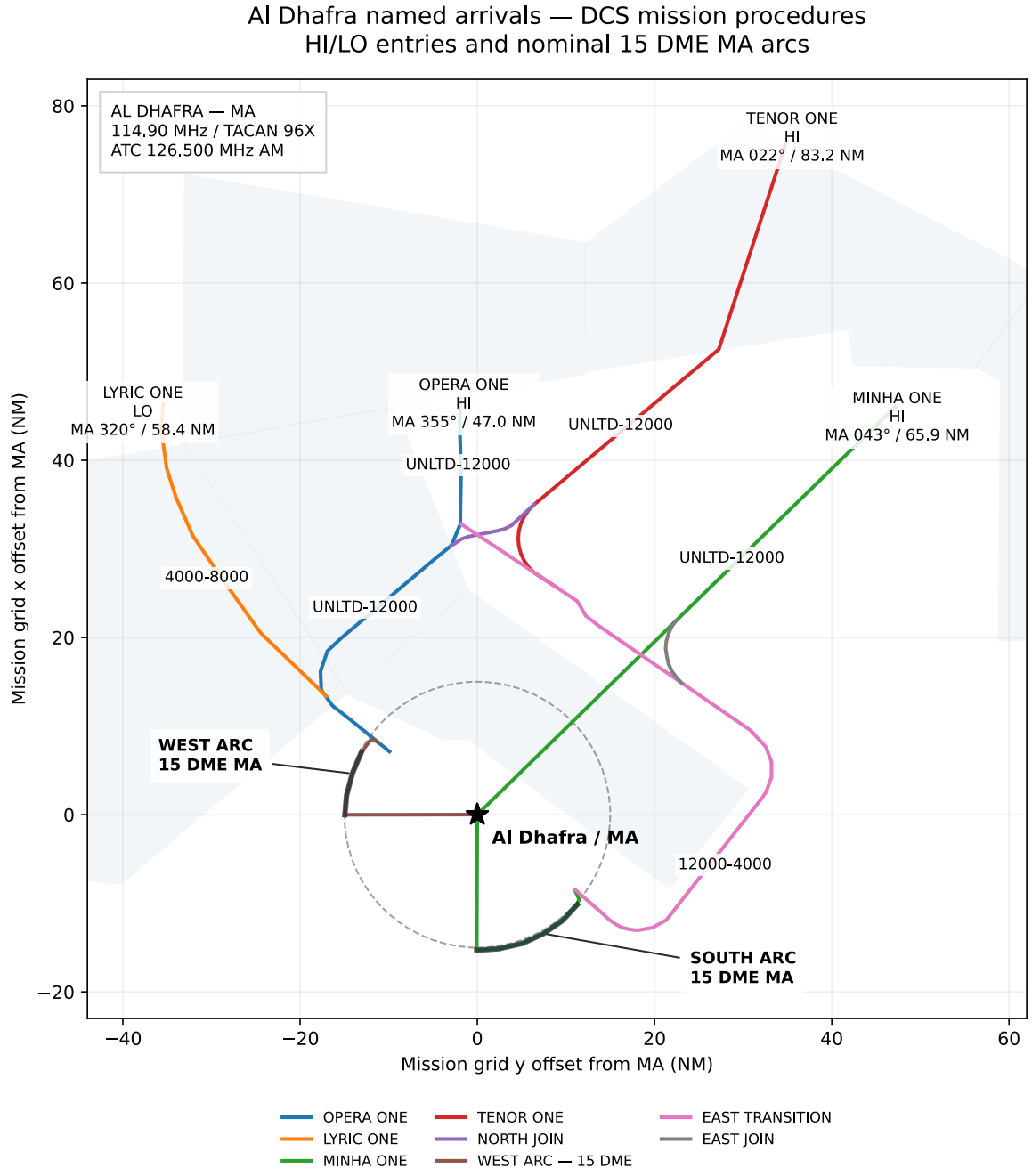
Table 7. Al Dhafra DME-arc transitions

Transition	DME reference / nominal distance	Drawn sector and use
WEST ARC	MA / 96X — 15 DME	West to northwest of MA. Used by the western-side arrival connection. The arc excludes the straight spoke to the station and the curved join at its outer end.
SOUTH ARC	MA / 96X — 15 DME	South to southeast of MA, at the end of the Al Minhad-side route. Connects with the eastern-side layout. The straight route through MA is not part of the arc.

4.3.8 Arc distance basis. Both 15 DME values are nominal procedure distances reconstructed from the mission drawings. The main western arc vertices lie 14.84–14.95 NM horizontally from MA; the main southern arc lies 15.17–15.39 NM away. Joining turns bend inside those ranges. The figure preserves the drawn geometry and adds a 15-NM plan-view reference circle; cockpit DME also includes the height difference to the station.

4.3.9 Draft procedure — flying the arc. Tune and identify MA, confirm the assigned arc and altitude, and maintain the nominal 15 DME indication while following the cleared direction. Confirm the arc exit and subsequent recovery instruction before turning onto the next leg. The drawn vertex order does not itself assign an inbound direction, magnetic radial, or runway.

4.3.10 Altitude bands. The source annotates HI routes as UNLTD-12000, the LO route as 4000-8000, and the eastern/southeastern segment as 12000-4000. These correspond to a high band at 12,000 and above, a low band from 4,000 to 8,000, and a connecting band from 4,000 to 12,000. The text objects do not specify units or altitude datum. Confirm those conventions and the transition clearance in the flight brief; do not silently substitute flight levels for the drawn numbers.



Entry labels: calculated magnetic FROM radials / horizontal map ranges; DCS magnetic model, June 2018.
Dashed circle: 15 NM plan-view reference. Cockpit DME measures slant range. See SPINS for altitude and route guidance.

Figure 2. Al Dhafra named arrivals and nominal 15 DME MA arcs. Original route geometry is preserved; procedure names and the distance reference are added for this mission.

4.3.11 TACAN-only cockpit guide

4.3.11.1 Equipment and setup. Use MA on TACAN 96X in ground transmit/receive mode, with TACAN selected as the navigation source. Identify MA and confirm valid bearing and distance indications. Use the aircraft’s normal heading indicator, altimeter, and a plotted route/briefing card. These instructions assume no GPS or INS steering.

4.3.11.2 Radial versus bearing. A radial is the magnetic direction FROM MA. The bearing-pointer head points TO MA; its reciprocal gives the FROM radial. For example, a bearing to MA of 175 degrees corresponds approximately to MA radial 355. Aircraft heading is a separate quantity. Read the radial and range together to locate the aircraft.

Table 8. Calculated MA planning checkpoints — magnetic FROM radials and horizontal map ranges

Checkpoint	MA radial (magnetic)	Map range (NM)
OPERA ONE entry	355°	47.0
MINHA ONE entry	043°	65.9
TENOR ONE entry	022°	83.2
LYRIC ONE entry	320°	58.4
NORTH JOIN branching area	007°	35.6
NORTH JOIN / OPERA ONE join	352°	30.5
LYRIC ONE / OPERA ONE join	305°	21.7
WEST ARC northwestern main-arc end	295°	14.9
WEST ARC western main-arc end	267°	14.9
SOUTH ARC southern main-arc end	177°	15.3
SOUTH ARC southeastern main-arc end	129°	15.2

4.3.11.3 Checkpoint basis. The radial references use the source vertices, a projection checked against 101 installed terrain beacon coordinates, and the installed DCS magnetic model for June 2018 (1.98 degrees east at MA). Values are rounded planning references. Main-arc endpoint entries locate the measured circular portions; joining turns extend beyond them. They are not assigned arc-entry or exit clearances.

4.3.11.4 Range interpretation. The table gives horizontal map range; TACAN displays slant range. Compare both radial and distance and account for altitude above MA. A point 15 NM horizontally from MA reads about 15.1 DME at 12,000 ft above the aid and about 15.7 DME at 28,000 ft above it. For WEST ARC or SOUTH ARC, the instructed nominal 15 DME is the cockpit indication. DME-derived speed and time-to-station reflect closure to MA; do not treat them as actual groundspeed while flying around the arc.

4.3.11.5 Flying a radial

leg. For a cleared straight leg along a MA radial, set the appropriate inbound or outbound course and correct for wind while monitoring course deviation and DME trend. MINHA ONE's initial straight leg is approximately MA radial 043 inbound toward MA; its reciprocal inbound course is approximately 223 degrees. Confirm the current indication and clearance before using those calculated values.

4.3.11.6 Flying the other route shapes. OPERA ONE, TENOR ONE, and LYRIC ONE include legs that are not a single MA radial or constant-distance arc. Use the plotted fix-to-fix headings and successive radial/range checkpoints to check progress. Turning the bearing pointer toward MA would cut across those routes. If the brief does not provide a usable leg heading and next checkpoint, obtain heading instructions before entering the constrained segment.

4.3.11.7 Joining the 15 DME

arc. Approach on the cleared intercept leg and lead the turn so that the aircraft rolls out tangent to the arc near 15 DME. Set turn lead for groundspeed, bank, and wind. Do not use a fixed lead distance for every aircraft or begin an unplanned turn at the civil boundary.

4.3.11.8 Maintaining the arc. For clockwise travel around MA, keep the station approximately abeam on the right; for counterclockwise travel, keep it approximately abeam on the left. Use small heading corrections and the DME trend: increasing range requires a correction toward MA, while decreasing range requires a correction away. Maintain the assigned altitude while monitoring the next FROM radial.

4.3.11.9 Leaving the arc. Before reaching the cleared exit radial, identify the subsequent course or heading and lead the turn to capture it. Confirm the radial, DME, and subsequent course before leaving the arc. Maintain the assigned altitude until cleared for a change; an arc exit does not clear descent through civil airspace or establish a final approach.

4.3.11.10 Station passage and degraded indications. Near or overhead MA, slant range need not reach zero and the bearing can change rapidly. Fly the briefed heading through station passage and confirm the outbound indication after it stabilizes. If identification, bearing, or range is lost, advise control, maintain the last safe assigned heading and altitude, and obtain revised instructions; do not enter another constrained segment on an unreliable fix.

4.3.11.11 Reporting example. “OPERA ONE, MA radial three five five, four seven DME, [assigned altitude], request WEST ARC transition.” Report the actual cockpit DME and state the altitude reference. A radial/range fix establishes position; it does not provide traffic separation by itself.

4.3.12 Draft procedure — entry selection. Brief the selected HI or LO branch using Table 5, the assigned altitude reference, and the intended transition to recovery. Contact Al Dhafra on 126.500 MHz AM with callsign, named arrival and transition, position, altitude, fuel state, and recovery intention. Example request: “Request OPERA ONE arrival, WEST ARC transition.” Obtain coordination before changing branch or altitude band.

4.3.13 Draft procedure — crossings and joins. Remain on the briefed branch through the civil-airspace crossings. Coordinate the LO-to-HI join and any use of the eastern connecting band in advance. Nearby Abu Dhabi control-area limits and the civil arrival/departure flows still apply to their respective traffic; a military route line does not itself clear a crossing.

4.3.14 Draft procedure — recovery handover. Obtain the runway, recovery sequence, and clearance from local control before leaving the entry route. An arrival name specifies the selected procedure; it does not by itself assign an altitude or landing clearance.

4.4 Al Minhad / OMDM

4.4.1 Mission definition. The source defines a hidden circular Al Minhad trigger zone with a 3,000-m radius. The Al Minhad-side HI connection to Al Dhafra is shown in Section 4.3. The zone itself does not define a circuit or instrument approach.

4.4.2 Draft procedure. Brief the military departure and recovery before launch. Coordinate the route from Al Minhad with the Dubai and Sharjah civil flows. Join MRR1 only after the assigned direction, level, and crossing have been deconflicted.

4.5 Dubai International / OMDB

4.5.1 Published traffic paths. Civil departures use OMDB_SID1, OMDB_SID2; arrivals use OMDB_STAR. Configured arrival entry points are IVOBA, ASNIS, KUMBO. These are the mission’s named drawing paths, not certified instrument charts.

4.5.2 Traffic behavior. Dubai departures are configured to appear airborne at 100 ft AGL and 170 KIAS; the configuration identifies runway 12R. Arrivals use a landing task. Expect runway-area traffic without a preceding taxi sequence.

4.5.3 Draft procedure. Keep clear of the depicted arrival and departure paths unless the flight has an assigned crossing. Check the runway and final approach even when no aircraft has taxied. At fields with runway-overflight arrivals, maintain separation until the aircraft has passed clear; do not assume it will stop on the runway.

4.6 Abu Dhabi International / OMAA

4.6.1 Published traffic paths. Civil departures use OMAA_SID1, OMAA_SID2; arrivals use OMAA_STAR. Configured arrival entry points are IVOBA, HSA. These are the mission’s named drawing paths, not certified instrument charts.

4.6.2 Traffic behavior. Departures are configured to appear airborne at 100 ft AGL and 170 KIAS; the configuration identifies runway 13R. Generated arrivals fly a runway overflight at 100 ft AGL rather than a landing task.

4.6.3 Draft procedure. Keep clear of the depicted arrival and departure paths unless the flight has an assigned crossing. Check the runway and final approach even when no aircraft has taxied. At fields with runway-overflight arrivals, maintain separation until the aircraft has passed clear; do not assume it will stop on the runway.

4.7 Sharjah International / OMSJ

4.7.1 Published traffic paths. Civil departures use OMSJ_SID1, OMSJ_SID2; arrivals use OMSJ_STAR. Configured arrival entry points are IVOBA, ASNIS, KUMBO. These are the mission’s named drawing paths, not certified instrument charts.

4.7.2 Traffic behavior. Departures are configured airborne at 100 ft AGL and 170 KIAS. Arrivals use a runway overflight at 100 ft AGL. Dubai and Sharjah departures also share a scheduling interval; this is not positive separation for military aircraft.

4.7.3 Draft procedure. Keep clear of the depicted arrival and departure paths unless the flight has an assigned crossing. Check the runway and final approach even when no aircraft has taxied. At fields with runway-overflight arrivals, maintain separation until the aircraft has passed clear; do not assume it will stop on the runway.

4.8 Ras Al Khaimah / OMRK

4.8.1 Published traffic paths.

Civil departures use OMRK_SID1, OMRK_SID2; arrivals use OMRK_STAR. Configured arrival entry points are IVOBA, ASNIS, KUMBO. These are the mission’s named drawing paths, not certified instrument charts.

4.8.2 Traffic behavior. Generated departures use parking rather than the airborne-runway mode. Arrivals use a runway overflight at 100 ft AGL. The OMRK CTA ceiling applies specifically to this airport’s generated traffic.

4.8.3 Draft procedure. Keep clear of the depicted arrival and departure paths unless the flight has an assigned crossing. Check the runway and final approach even when no aircraft has taxied. At fields with runway-overflight arrivals, maintain separation until the aircraft has passed clear; do not assume it will stop on the runway.

4.9 Fujairah International / OMFJ

4.9.1 Published traffic paths. Civil departures use OMFJ_SID1, OMFJ_SID2; arrivals use OMFJ_STAR. Configured arrival entry points are LUDID, RASKI, PARAR. These are the mission’s named drawing paths, not certified instrument charts.

4.9.2 Traffic behavior. Departures are configured airborne at 100 ft AGL and 170 KIAS. Arrivals use a runway overflight at 100 ft AGL. The OMFJ CTA ceiling applies specifically to this airport’s generated traffic.

4.9.3 Draft procedure. Keep clear of the depicted arrival and departure paths unless the flight has an assigned crossing. Check the runway and final approach even when no aircraft has taxied. At fields with runway-overflight arrivals, maintain separation until the aircraft has passed clear; do not assume it will stop on the runway.

5 Carrier operations

5.1 Carrier group. Carrier Strike Group 8 contains CVN-75 Harry S. Truman, CG-50 Valley Forge, DDG-96 Bainbridge, DDG-67 Cole, and DDG-107 Gravely. The carrier has a two-point route; it is not stationary. No cyclic launch/recovery schedule, final bearing, or recovery case is supplied.

5.2 Draft procedure — departure. Obtain the assigned departure, initial altitude, radio transfer, and route to the operating area. Maintain awareness of the actual ship position and civil traffic. Do not use the distant fixed CATCC rectangle as a substitute for local carrier traffic instructions.

5.3 Draft procedure — recovery. Call the carrier on the channel in Table 1 and obtain current recovery instructions. Confirm the beacon discrepancy has been resolved, establish the assigned recovery case and sequence, and report fuel or system limitations before committing. No marshal radial, holding altitude, or emergency divert is invented here.

5.4 Plane guard and recovery tanker. The SH-60B and S-3B exist as late-activation templates. The inspected triggers do not activate them. Treat rescue and recovery-tanker coverage as unavailable until specifically verified or added by the mission maker.

6 Civil air traffic and maritime restrictions

6.1 Civil traffic picture.

The embedded traffic generator is configured for up to 40 active aircraft, with a startup target of half that limit. It adds airport arrivals and departures, with entry and exit altitude selections of 30,000–40,000 ft. Actual numbers and flight paths depend on initialization, aircraft availability, traffic spacing, and AI behavior.

Table 9. Civil traffic entry gates and shared exits

Airport flow	Arrival gates	Departure exits
DXB	IVOBA, ASNIS, KUMBO	LOTAV, REXOD, TOTOX, PARAR, RASKI, LUDID
AUH	IVOBA, HSA	LOTAV, REXOD, TOTOX, PARAR, RASKI, LUDID
SHJ	IVOBA, ASNIS, KUMBO	LOTAV, REXOD, TOTOX, PARAR, RASKI, LUDID
RKT	IVOBA, ASNIS, KUMBO	LOTAV, REXOD, TOTOX, PARAR, RASKI, LUDID
FJR	LUDID, RASKI, PARAR	LOTAV, REXOD, TOTOX, PARAR, RASKI, LUDID

6.2 Draft procedure — unidentified traffic. Do not classify a contact as hostile solely from its presence in an operating area, airline paint scheme, lack of response, or map label. Report identity uncertainty and keep clear while it is resolved. Flight tasking must supply the applicable engagement authority.

6.3
Shipping. The shipping script is configured for up to 40 generated neutral vessels using the named port and sea-lane network. It applies a 0.5-NM lane offset and a 2-NM spawn-spacing criterion. These are generator parameters, not protected approach distances or weapons-release criteria.

6.4 BLOCKADE_HORMUZ. The mission defines a circular shipping blockade with a radius of 30,480 m (16.46 NM). The shipping generator adds a 0.5-NM buffer, plans to stop another 1 NM short, and seeks a holding position within its configured 5-NM holding radius. These are maritime-routing constraints; no airspace floor or ceiling is assigned.

6.5 Draft procedure — blockade and surface contacts. Expect neutral traffic to hold outside the blockade rather than disappear. Do not interpret stopping, holding, or approaching a port as engagement authority. Coordinate any flight activity over the blockade with the mission controller and keep the maritime restriction separate from aircraft clearances.

6.6 Minerva Nike. Minerva Nike is a blue-side merchant-vessel group with a unit-linked 3,000-m zone. The source does not publish a visit, boarding, attack, or rescue task for that vessel. Its presence and associated zone do not constitute player tasking.

7 Abnormal procedures and reporting

7.1 Draft procedure — lost communications. Attempt the last assigned agency and channel, then the prebriefed alternate or relay. Avoid uncoordinated entry into occupied control areas. Use the flight’s published lost-communications route and recovery decision; if none exists, settle it during the flight brief before departure.

7.2 Draft procedure — fuel or aircraft emergency. Advise the controlling agency of callsign, position, altitude, nature of the emergency, fuel/endurance, and intended action. Request priority and coordinate the recovery location. An unverified tanker is not an emergency-fuel plan.

7.3 Draft procedure — traffic conflict. Maintain aircraft control, report the conflict, and coordinate the maneuver and subsequent clearance. The civil scripts do not provide a live controller or guarantee that AI aircraft remain within their planned altitude and lateral limits.

7.4

1. Entry/exit report: callsign, named measure, position, altitude, and next intention.
2. Support request: callsign, requested service, position, fuel/endurance, and aircraft limitations.
3. Mission completion: assigned task result, losses or damage, remaining stores and fuel, and recovery intention.
4. Discrepancy report: observed condition, location/time, affected flight, and the specific instruction or aid involved.

Annex A Mission-maker decisions and source traceability

1 Release status. This annex records the remaining decisions needed to issue the draft for player operations. It does not alter the source mission. The flight procedures above are proposed instructions; their existence in this document does not create simulator services or enforcement.

Table 10. Decisions required before issue

Item	Direct source evidence	Required resolution
Carrier navigation	Briefing: TACAN 4X. Programmed carrier task: 75X / KU and ICLS 5.	Choose the intended aid and align the mission and briefing. Draft service table reports the programmed values.
ARCO availability	Briefing: 210 AM / 11Y. Present tanker template: TEXACO 1-1, 251 MHz / 1X, late activation.	Provide and verify the intended tanker, or remove it from support planning.
AWACS / rescue availability	E-2C and SH-60B are late-activation templates without a matching inspected activation action.	Activate and configure the intended services or explicitly plan without them.
Carrier-control geometry	Carrier starts approximately 58.9 NM outside the fixed CVN75_CATCC rectangle.	Confirm whether the drawing is an intended operating box or needs relocation/replacement.
Player tasking and SCL	No Player/Client aircraft, blue tasking text, or player loadouts are present.	Supply player access, flight assignments, targets, payloads, fuel limits, and recovery/alternate plans.
Control staffing and clearance	Civil airspace definitions and traffic-routing logic are present; human agencies are not assigned.	Assign controllers/channels or brief explicit flight-to-flight deconfliction before issue.
Altitude and time conventions	Map uses FL labels; script limits use feet MSL. Mission clock starts 06:00 with no verified UTC offset.	Brief altimeter/flight-level conventions and the common clock. Do not silently equate the two altitude references.

Item	Direct source evidence	Required resolution
Vertical separation	Civil-volume floors/ceilings are recorded in the traffic script; the 1,000-ft military planning margin is authored for this draft. OPERA ONE has a CTR crossing requiring profile resolution.	Confirm the margin and flight-specific vertical profile. Complete altitude changes outside occupied civil bands or coordinate a crossing.
TACAN-only navigation	Calculated MA radials use verified terrain projection and the installed DCS June 2018 magnetic model. The map’s range is horizontal; the aircraft shows slant range.	Brief the full leg headings, assigned arc entry/exit, altitude reference, and recovery clearance. Check the reference values in the cockpit before issue.
Al Dhafra route conventions	Common-layer HI/LO routes include UNLTD-12000, 4000-8000, and 12000-4000 text. WEST ARC and SOUTH ARC are nominal 15 DME MA reconstructed from approximate linework.	Confirm altitude conventions, arc direction/exits, and recovery clearance. Check the named procedures in DCS before issue.
Engagement permissions	No blue mission task or player rules of engagement are published.	Define target authorization, identification, restrictions, and abort criteria in tasking.

Table 11. Al Dhafra procedure-to-drawing mapping

Published mission name	Original source objects
OPERA ONE (OPERA1)	Line-1
MINHA ONE (MINHA1)	Line-10
TENOR ONE (TENOR1)	Line-13, Line-14
LYRIC ONE (LYRIC1)	Line-6
WEST ARC	Line-11 curved portion; main measured vertices 2–5
SOUTH ARC	Line-10 southern curved portion; main measured vertices 3–8
EAST TRANSITION	Line-7
EAST JOIN	Line-12
NORTH JOIN	Line-14

2 Source selection. The source is the spaced filename Operation Steel Opera.miz, SHA-256 6a9bfb403461d4ea04bd3e2ffb26e8c36817a5f07a4073b50d96f57e3d712922. The newer hyphenated file was identified but not substituted.

3 Verification boundary. The archive, embedded script configuration, drawing geometry, and installed terrain radio data were inspected. No mission script was executed and no DCS session was flown. Configured traffic, beacons, runway behavior, and support availability still require in-simulator verification.

References

1. Operation Steel Opera.miz — exact source archive, mission; l10n/DEFAULT/ dictionary; warehouses. SHA-256 6a9bfb403461d4ea04bd3e2ffb26e8c36817a5f07a4073b50d96f57e3d712922.
2. Embedded Air Traffic configuration and route logic, mission.trigrules[1].actions[1].text; CONFIG.airspaces, CONFIG.no_go, CONFIG.airports.
3. Embedded Shipping Traffic configuration and blockade logic, mission.trigrules[2].actions[1].text; CONFIG and read_blockades.
4. Installed Persian Gulf terrain radio database, DCS World OpenBeta/Mods/ terrains/PersianGulf/radio.lua; local DCS log identifies build 2.9.29.27468.
5. FAA AIM, Navigation Aids — DME and VORTAC, Sections 1-1-6 and 1-1-7; DME measures slant range in nautical miles.
6. FAA ATC, Arrival Procedures — arrival name and number, Naming convention reference only; the mission names below are newly authored.
7. FAA Instrument Flying Handbook, Navigation Systems, Chapter 9, DME arc and lead-radial technique; aircraft-specific controls remain in the relevant flight manual.
8. Calculated MA magnetic radial/range planning checkpoints, Source mission route vertices; Persian Gulf projection checked against 101 installed beacon coordinate pairs; installed DCS magvar model initialized to June 2018 at MA. These are calculated references, not live cockpit checks..
9. Al Dhafra HI/LO entry-route drawings and altitude annotations, mission.drawings, Common layer: Line-1, Line-6, Line-7, Line-10, Line-11, Line-12, Line-13, Line-14 and HI/LO text objects. MA reference position: PersianGulf/beacons.lua, airfield4_8..

Distribution

- Mission maker
- Flight leads
- Designated controllers